

Name: _____

Date: _____

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to select precise vocabulary by understanding shades of meaning between synonyms and using antonyms and connotations effectively.

KEY IDEA

Synonyms have similar meanings but different CONNOTATIONS (feelings and associations) and INTENSITY. 'Walked' vs 'strolled' vs 'marched' vs 'stumbled' — all mean moving on foot, but each creates a completely different image. Precise word choice is the mark of a skilled writer.

WARM UP — QUICK CHECK!

List 3 synonyms for 'happy' that show DIFFERENT levels of intensity (mild → strong):

mild: _____

medium: _____

intense: _____

Write the antonym of 'generous':

A — FIND THE ANTONYM

Write the best antonym for each word:

generous

ancient

victory

genuine

transparent

courageous

expand

optimistic

B — RANK BY INTENSITY

Rank each set of synonyms from MILDEST (1) to STRONGEST (4):

Angry: furious, annoyed, irritated, enraged

1 (mildest)

2

3

4 (strongest)

Happy: content, ecstatic, pleased, overjoyed

1 (mildest)

2

3

4 (strongest)

C — CHOOSE THE PRECISE WORD

Replace the bold word with a MORE PRECISE synonym that fits the context perfectly:

1. The thief walked silently through the dark, empty house.

2. The exhausted marathon runner walked across the finish line.

3. The toddler walked unsteadily across the living room floor.

D — CONNOTATION MATTERS

The words 'slim', 'skinny' and 'slender' are all synonyms for thin. Explain the DIFFERENT connotations of each word and which you would use in each context:

In a fashion magazine:

In a medical report expressing concern:

As a compliment to a friend:

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept e.g. content (mild), happy (medium), ecstatic (intense). Antonym of generous: stingy/mean/selfish.

A: stingy/mean, modern/contemporary, defeat/loss, fake/false, opaque, cowardly, shrink/contract, pessimistic.

B: Angry 1-4: annoyed, irritated, furious, enraged. Happy 1-4: content, pleased, overjoyed, ecstatic (accept reasonable variation).

C1: Accept: crept, slunk, tiptoed — stealth words.

C2: Accept: stumbled, staggered, trudged — exhaustion words.

C3: Accept: tottered, waddled, toddled — unsteady words.

D: slender = elegant, positive connotation. skinny = slight concern, could be negative. slim = neutral to positive. Accept personal reasoning.

High Five! You are a Language Champion! ✓
Colour a star for each section you completed successfully:



EXTENSION / CHALLENGE

Choose an overused word like 'good', 'nice', 'said' or 'big'. Find 10 more precise synonyms for it and create a 'word upgrade' poster — show different contexts where each synonym fits best.

PARENT TIP

Play a 'word upgrade' game: say a simple word like 'big' and take turns finding more precise alternatives. Discuss the subtle differences in feeling — massive vs enormous vs colossal.

TEACHER TIP

Use a thesaurus to explore shades of meaning — not just direct substitution. Discuss connotation vs denotation using example sentences. Connect to writing improvement through word choice revision.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- [] I can identify antonyms and synonyms with different levels of intensity
- [] I can rank synonyms by their connotation and emotional intensity
- [] I can select precise vocabulary to suit the specific context and purpose